Operational Trust Evaluation Module (OTEM)

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Canonical Definition

Operational Trust Evaluation Module (OTEM) defines the structural conditions under which operational trust is evaluated, measured, justified, and continuously reassessed throughout autonomous operation.

OTEM governs operational trust evaluation.

The module establishes the governance conditions required to ensure that confidence in autonomous operational actors remains evidence-based, measurable, justified, and governance-valid.

Trust should not be assumed.

Trust should be continuously evaluated.

OTEM governs that evaluation.

Module Operational Role

OTEM defines the operational trust evaluation layer of ARTS.

Its role is to continuously evaluate whether autonomous operations remain sufficiently trustworthy under current operational conditions.

Module Operational Space

OTEM governs:

- operational trust evaluation,
- trust measurement,
- trust assessment,
- justified operational confidence,
- governance trust evaluation,
- trust verification,
- continuous trust assessment,
- operational trust governance.

Module Function

The module applies wherever organizations must continuously evaluate the trustworthiness of autonomous operational actors and their operations.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Trust Evaluation Object

Identify which autonomous operational activities require continuous trust evaluation.

2. Define Trust Evaluation Conditions

Establish governance conditions governing how operational trust is measured and justified.

3. Define Trust Evaluation Failure Logic

Identify conditions where operational trust becomes unjustified, degraded, unverifiable, or governance-invalid.

4. Define Governance Response

Define governance actions for trust confirmation, operational restriction, increased monitoring, escalation, or corrective intervention.

5. Preserve Trust Traceability

Preserve trust evaluations, governance decisions, operational evidence, trust history, and supporting documentation.

Use Case 1 — Autonomous Public Transport System

Scenario

An autonomous passenger transport system continuously operates across a metropolitan transit network.

Application

OTEM continuously evaluates operational trust based on system performance, governance compliance, and operational reliability.

Result

Public transportation remains supported by continuously justified operational trust.

Use Case 2 — Multi-Agent Enterprise Environment

Scenario

Multiple autonomous AI agents collaborate to perform critical enterprise operations.

Application

OTEM continuously evaluates trust in each operational actor throughout coordinated execution.

Result

The organization maintains measurable, evidence-based trust across the autonomous operational ecosystem.

Canonical Closing Statement

**Trustworthy autonomy requires continuously justified trust.
Operational Trust Evaluation ensures that confidence in autonomous operations remains measurable, evidence-based, and continuously governed throughout the complete operational lifecycle.**

Related Documents

→ Autonomous Risk & Trust Standard (ARTS)

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Canonical Source

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